

Most people have never heard of the Iningai.

This is what happened here, told by the people it happened to.

Start from the beginning ↓

On the live page this scrolls the reader to the oldest section, at the bottom.

AHEAD

What is being built

● WITHIN FIVE YEARS

The Cultural Knowledge Precinct

Exhibitions, teaching, research accommodation and a place for community to gather, in one place at Turraburra. Master planning is underway.

It is being built because there is something here worth building it for.

WRITTEN RECORD

Talk to us about being part of it →

TODAY

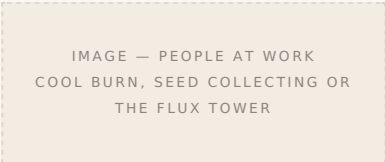
The work going on

● NOW

Right-way fire, springs, and two flux towers

The Iningai Rangers burn, fence, collect seed and bring springs back. Two towers measure what that does to the carbon in the soil — one on Country managed this way, one on grazed land, checked against each other.

They can do this work because, seven years ago, this stopped being someone else's station.



LIVING MEMORY

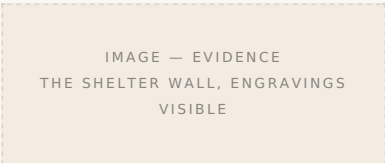
What the towers are showing →

● 2022

The site is studied with its owners

A two-year study documents Marra Wonga from both archaeological and Iningai perspectives, with Iningai community members as research partners rather than subjects. Ten clusters of engravings, read south to north, tell the Seven Sisters in sequence.

Iningai people could be partners in that research because, by then, there were Iningai people the researchers had to ask.



SCIENCE

Read the findings →

2019

Bought back

2019

Gracevale becomes Turraburra

8,870 hectares are bought for the custodians of the Iningai people through YACHATDAC, with the Indigenous Land and Sea Corporation. The station changes hands, and changes name.

Which raises the question of how it came to be somebody else’s to sell.

WRITTEN RECORD

How the buyback happened →

1950s

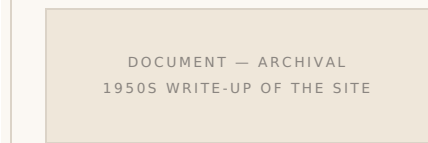
Admired under the wrong name

1950s

They called it The Art Gallery

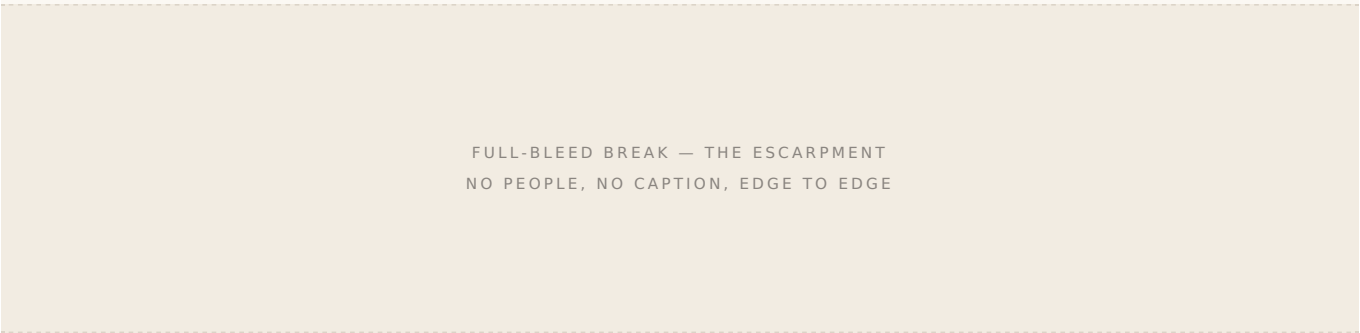
By the 1950s the escarpment has a name given to it by visitors, and it is not an Iningai one. The site is written up, photographed and admired under that name for decades.

Nobody corrected them, because by then there was almost nobody left to do it.



WRITTEN RECORD

Who named it, and what it was called before →



1902, AND THEN FURTHER BACK

DRAFT — SUZANNE'S WORDS, AWAITING HER APPROVAL

Taken from the Unfinished Business and Yacadak Framework recordings and lightly edited for reading. Nothing here is published until she has seen it and signed it off.

By 1902 there were thirty-five.



TOLD BY

Suzanne Thompson

Iningai custodian · Founder and Managing Director, YACHATDAC

And I'm a descendant of one of those 35.

To understand that number you have to go back sixteen years, to a drought, and to a decision made out of concern.

1902

35

Iningai people left.

1886

7,500

Blankets calculated as necessary for the Iningai nation, sixteen years earlier. When they arrived, some still had to be cut in half, because there were not enough to go round.

In 1886 the settlers had all come, and they'd established about 150 property landholdings. It was a great drought, and they were really concerned about the poor condition of the natives. Winter was coming. They were worried, because our people were off their lands and couldn't hunt, and had no access to their country or their foods.

So they decided we needed blankets.

What was written in the history books afterwards is that we did not exist, that we had no rights, that we had been wiped out. Up until seven years ago, by the government's account, Iningai people did not exist at all.

Well — we're still here.

Our ancestors were dispossessed and massacred in a way that meant we never got to complete the proper cultural ceremony for that grieving. Another belief arrived and said it is done this way now. That is unfinished business. There are massacre sites out here. We know where they are.

My great-great-great grandmother Polly. My great-great-great grandfather Billy. That is how I know where to hunt, and which springs to visit, and why my family is still on this Country.

FOR SUZANNE TO CHECK

Every line above is yours, edited only for reading, and re-ordered so the count of thirty-five comes before the blankets. Tell us if that reversal is wrong — it is your story and it may want telling forwards.

BUILD NOTE

The descent stops here. No rail, no markers, nothing else on screen, and no way past it. It resumes below, older.

1840s

Before the runs were taken up

1840s

What Mitchell recorded

The explorer Thomas Mitchell passes through and describes the Iningai — including huts built solidly enough to carry bark tiles on the roof.

The first written account of the people here was written by someone who had just arrived. Everyone who could have written it earlier had no reason to.

DOCUMENT — NOT A PHOTO
SCAN OF THE JOURNAL PAGE

WRITTEN RECORD

[Read the passage, and what it proves →](#)

OLDER THAN THE RECORD

Cut into the wall

AT LEAST 5,000 YEARS AGO

The engraving starts

Over 15,000 petroglyphs and 111 stencils accumulate along 160 metres of shelter wall — animal tracks, lines, grooves, drilled holes, and human feet with six toes.

People were marking this wall for thousands of years before anyone arrived to write a word about them.

Dating under review — see note in the copy doc.

SCIENCE

[What the study found, and how →](#)

BEFORE PEOPLE

All of this was under water

ABOUT 100 MILLION YEARS AGO

The Eromanga Sea

Most of inland Queensland is under water. The sediment settling on its floor becomes the sandstone the shelter is cut from. A seven-metre plant eater walks its shoreline, and will not be found until 1963.

Even the wall they marked was made by something older than marking.

SCIENCE

[How the seabed became the escarpment →](#)

UNDERNEATH ALL OF IT

Wattanuri, and the sisters he followed

The Seven Sisters travel across the sky and across the country, pursued. What they did on that journey shaped landforms that are still standing, and one figure at the southern end of the shelter is the pursuer himself.

This is not at the bottom of the page because it is the oldest thing on it. Lore is not a date. It is the floor everything above has been resting on the whole way down — which is why the band has run beside the reader since the first screen.

[As much as is told away from Country →](#)

Below this the page continues with the browsable record — every article, account, recording and paper — then the research findings, open research, partnerships and the enquiry form.